Marine Environmental Data and Information Network (MEDIN)

How to use the MEDIN import manager

'Measure once, use many times'

This document demonstrates how to use the MEDIN import manager and provides resources and contact details for support.

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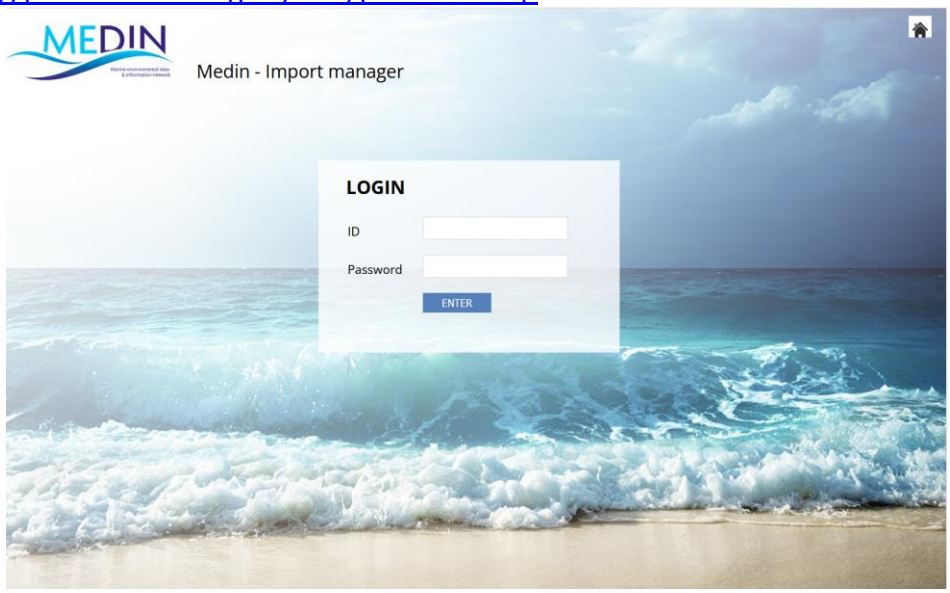
1 Introduction to the MEDIN Import Manager

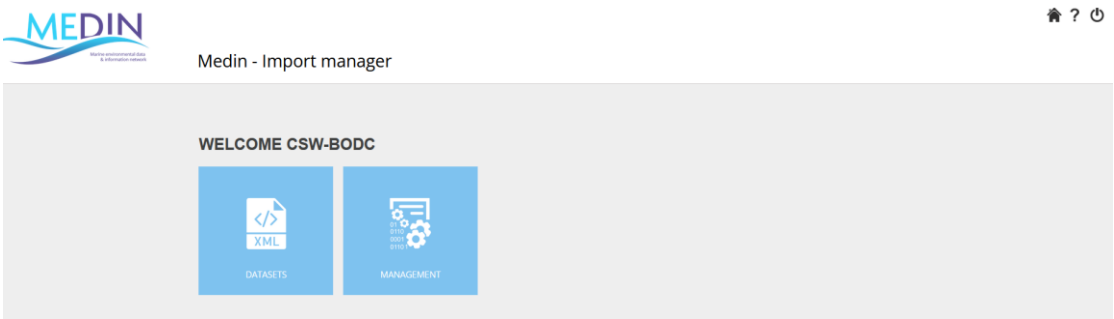
The MEDIN import manager is used by MEDIN metadata suppliers to monitor and view any errors in their records. These metadata collections are then published online in the MEDIN Portal.

To log into the MEDIN import manager go to https://portal.medin.org.uk/cms/password.asp



Each supplier has their own login information and if you do not know your ID and Password, please contact enquiries@medin.org.uk.

The homepage will be different for each metadata supplier, and this is the example for BODC:



The icons in the top right-hand corner operate as follows:

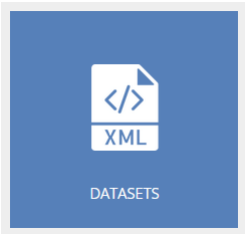
The “home” button in the top left will take you back to the login page

The “power” button in the top left will take you back a page

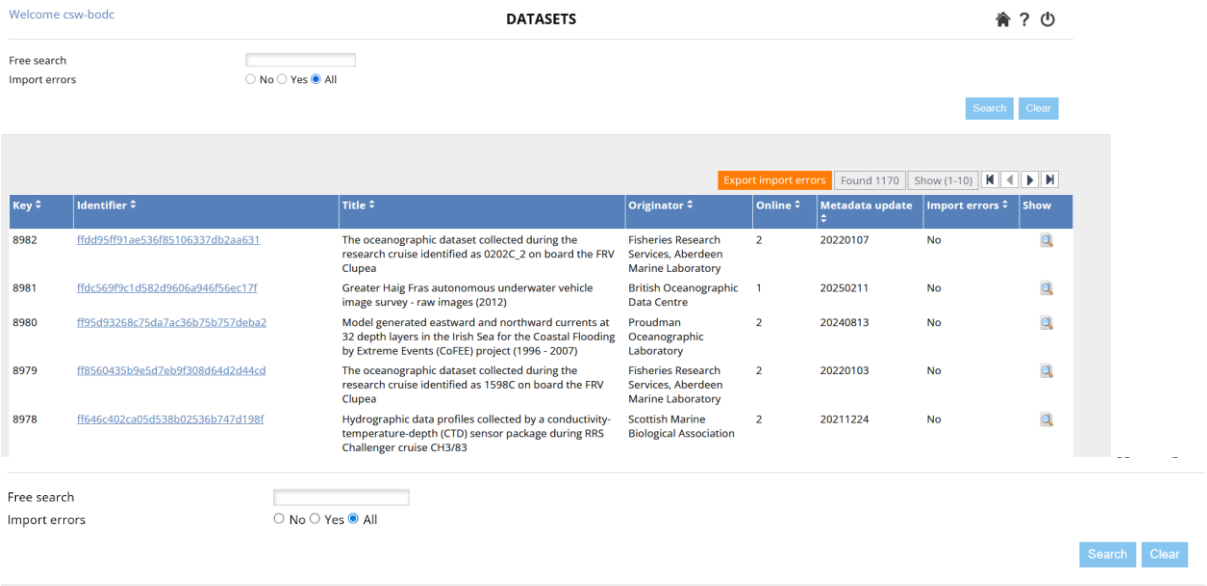
The “question mark” button in the top left will lead you to this document

2 Import manager ‘Datasets’ page

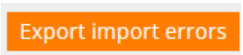
Clicking on the “Datasets” button will show a table of all of your harvested records.



There is a free text search box at the top of the page where you can search for records within any of the metadata fields. You can then select whether to include import errors (No, Yes or All) in the search. You can select the blue “search” box to return results or “clear” to start the search again.



You can order and filter the table using the small arrows in each column. The ‘Identifier’ is the persistent identifier of the record in the portal and clicking on the identifier will take you to the live record.

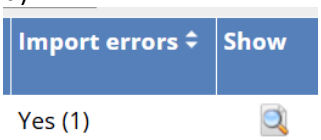
The orange 

button will automatically export all your import errors into a CSV file. If your file is empty, it means you have no errors!

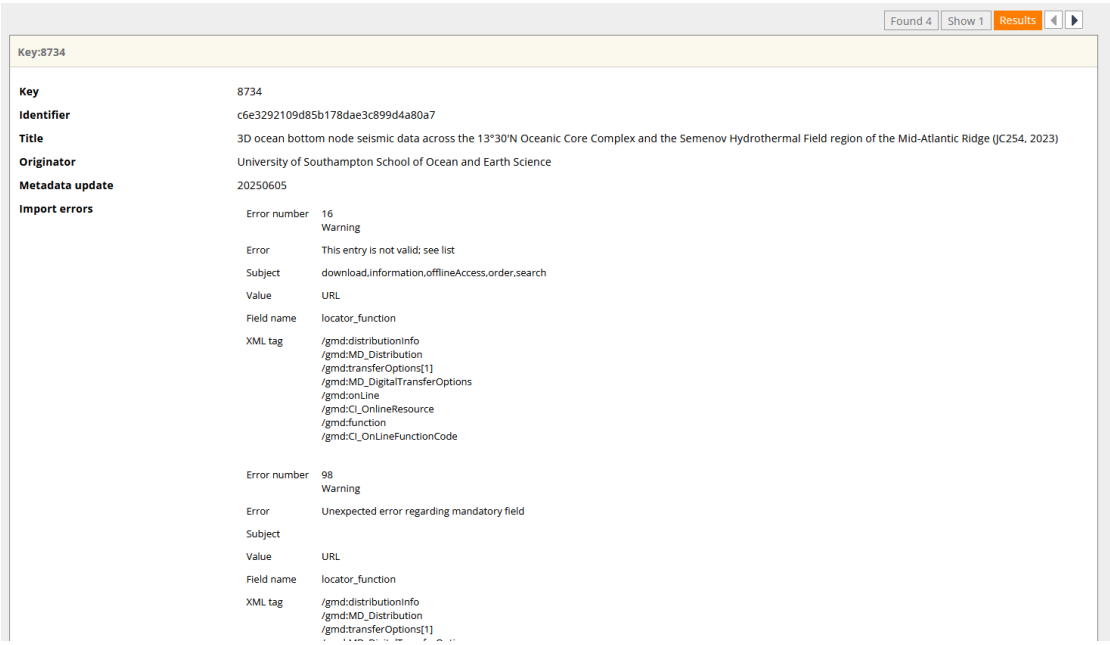
An example of a CSV of exported errors:

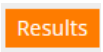
input_date	partner	title	main_cod	error_num	file_name	field_elem	field_nam	field_xmltag
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2013,	4589	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_29e3d0147f701677c9e66c785c4c85a9.xml	22.0.7	role	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2010,	4590	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a43774f41b6589ba15dbdb9392857fa.xml	22.0.2	organisati	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2010,	4590	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a43774f41b6589ba15dbdb9392857fa.xml	22.0.6	email	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2010,	4590	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a43774f41b6589ba15dbdb9392857fa.xml	22.0.7	role	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2012-	4591	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a467083-834e-4d0b-bc77-bf645fdea3b0.xml	16.2	date_publ	gmd:identificationInfo/gmd:MD_DataIdentification/gmd:citation/gmd
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2012-	4591	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a467083-834e-4d0b-bc77-bf645fdea3b0.xml	20	constrainl	gmd:identificationInfo/gmd:MD_DataIdentification/gmd:resourceCon
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2012-	4591	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a467083-834e-4d0b-bc77-bf645fdea3b0.xml	22.0.2	organisati	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2012-	4591	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a467083-834e-4d0b-bc77-bf645fdea3b0.xml	22.0.6	email	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD_
02/01/2026 08:31	15	2012-	4591	1	e:\internet\medin\import_csw\20260201_073055_272\015_2a467083-834e-4d0b-bc77-bf645fdea3b0.xml	22.0.7	role	gmd:distributionInfo/gmd:MD_Distribution/gmd:distributor/gmd:MD

If you do have an error(s) the 'Import Errors' column will show 'Yes (and number of errors in brackets for each metadata record)':



Clicking the magnifying glass in the 'Show' column will display the error(s) in more detail for each record:



Click the orange 

button to go back to the list of records and the forward and back buttons to scroll through each metadata record with errors.

Descriptions for 'Error number' can be found in Appendix 4.1.

3 Import manager 'Management' page

Clicking on 'Management' will show a table summarising the metadata collection and the numbers of metadata with errors, the number of errors and the top errors ordered by most numerous first. There are information pop up boxes clarifying what each heading means.

Management info	6
Total records count	1170
Records with errors	4
Records with no errors	1166
Max number of record errors	6
Total error count	10

Top error overview

Top Errors	Error Number	Error Field	Error Appendix
2	61	west	12.1

Error Sample

Error number	61 Warning
Error	East has smaller coordinate value than west
Subject	
Value	-0.073706
Field name	west
XML tag	/gmd:identificationInfo /gmd:MD_DataIdentification /gmd:extent /gmd:EX_Extent /gmd:geographicElement[1] /gmd:EX_GeographicBoundingBox /gmd:westBoundLongitude /gco:Decimal

Top Errors	Error Number	Error Field	Error Appendix
1	1	metadata_name	27

Error Sample

Error number	1 Warning
Error	Mandatory field missing
Subject	
Value	
Field name	metadata_name
XML tag	/gmd:metadataStandardName /gco:CharacterString

The headings are as follows:
'Management info' is an internal identifier for the supplier of the metadata.
'Total records count' is the total number of records harvested from a metadata supplier
'Records with errors' are the number of harvested records that present with errors
'Records with no errors' are the number of harvested records that are error-free
'Max number of record errors' is the maximum number of errors found in any one record
'Total error count' is the total number of errors combined for all harvested records

4 Contact Us

If you have any questions about the import manager, or if you have any feedback, please email enquiries@medin.org.uk.

5 APPENDICES

5.1 *Error numbers and descriptions*

```
Error 1 "Mandatory field missing"
Error 2 "String too long; exceeds field length"
Error 3 "Manual library value not found"
Error 4 "Numeric test failed"
Error 5 "Latitude range is -90 <value> +90"
Error 6 "Longitude range is -180 <value> +180"
Error 7 "Library entry not found"
Error 8 "Not conform ISO date specification"
Error 9 "No legal XML-file"
Error 10 "Error in executing DTS file "
Error 11 "Error in SQL statement "
Error 12 "No valid coordinate"
Error 13 "No valid inserted n_code"
Error 14 "No main-data found in xml"
Error 15 "Only one such element is allowed in this XML file"
Error 16 "This entry is not valid; see list"
Error 17 "This entry is not valid; It has to start with"
Error 18 "Resource type not available; no validation possible"
Error 19 "No decimals found"
Error 20 "More than one decimal point found"
Error 21 "A minimum of two decimals should be provided"
Error 22 "Not a positive integer"
Error 23 "No limitation on public access found"
Error 24 "Conditions applied for access and use are not filled"
Error 25 "No organisation with role Originator found"
Error 26 "No organisation with role Distributor found"
Error 27 "No organisation with role Custodian found"
Error 28 "No organisation with role PointOfContact found"
Error 29 "Only one resource example allowed"
Error 60 "North has smaller coordinate value than south "
Error 61 "East has smaller coordinate value than west"
Error 62 "Metadata date not filled as date or as datatime"
Error 63 "Coordinates north and/or south not filled"
Error 64 "Coordinates east and/or west not filled"
Error 65 "The minimum length for abstract is 100 characters."
Error 66 "No organisation with role owner found"
Error 81 "Unexpected error medin_check_lib"
Error 82 "Unexpected error medin_check_number"
Error 83 "Unexpected error medin_check_lat_lng"
Error 84 "Unexpected error medin_check_tag_count"
Error 86 "Unexpected error medin_check_date"
Error 87 "Unexpected error medin_check_len"
Error 88 "Unexpected error medin_check_string"
Error 98 "Unexpected error regarding mandatory field"
```

5.2 *Supplier identifiers (or TPC codes)*

These codes are found in the individual metadata record URL so a supplier can easily identify metadata from their own collection by this code, for example,

https://portal.medin.org.uk/portal/start.php?details&**tpc=006**_e405bb18e41b5f41a40c03723bbc9280

for BODC record '*Hydrographic data profiles collected by a conductivity-temperature-depth (CTD) sensor package during RRS Discovery cruise D82B*'

Supplier name	TPC code
BODC	006
NRW	007
Cefas	009
DASSH	010
MDSG	012
UKHO	014
TCE	015
BGS	016